6/15/56 Next Generation of Computers

Hurd

Blaauw (Decimal ?)

Fagg

Gregory (Decimal ?)

Buchholz

Pendery

Rochester

Griffith

Lawless

Dunwell

Bashe

Coombs

Haddad

Rabenbamps

1) Hurd opens with probinary statements:

a) I/O solves differences

b) sophistication of customers is better now

c) MPD will not take Decimal - I/O is binary

d) Don't worry about education

2) Hurd: Checking

a) CE's need checking to reduce workload

b) Customers would rather have checking to help out CE's

c) MPD must have checking to guarantee performance specifications. They may demand that any checking be at least equivalent to duplicate circuitry guarantees

d) Customers are prob. willing to pay more for checking

3) Hurd: Generality of I/O equipment

a) STRETCH proposal looks adequate to satisfy all groups.

4) Hurd: Proposes problem in which the code for a Dec and Bin machines would be explicitly written and compared on the same sheet of paper

5) Haddad: Present plans include flexible logic which satisfies both B & D proponents - Therefore, the question is largely academic

6) Haddad – Memory organization is more basic than character representation, et al. Decimal customer should be convinced that he is not paying excessively for Binary features

7) Aurd: Sales needs a set of "magic" words to describe the machine to the customer

8) Dennewell: Stretch Intentions

1. Use any Code with I/O
   a) Convert to usable code with mapping
2. Memory addressing binary to facilitate mapping
   a. for Decimal tables, either
      1. Convert 10 → 2
      2. Waste some space
      3. If 1.2, not convenient, build in conversion
3. Each Computer will provide both base 2 + 10 arith unit
4. Instructions will be binary
5. Fast arith will be binary
6. Logic will be handled as binary
7. Variable Field and record size will be provided

9) Write on selling Bin mach to decimal addicts

10) STRETCH machines may be considered as logical Power stations, and therefore must be capable of unattended operation in the same manner. The unit should capable of operating when some of the components are out of order.